

Hearing Aid Styles

There are four common hearing aid styles. The right choice depends on your degree of hearing loss, dexterity, lifestyle and preferences.

Style	How it sits	Suits	Battery life	Notes
Behind-the-ear (BTE)	Behind the ear, tube or wire to the canal	Mild to profound	Full day (rechargeable)	Most powerful; longest battery life
Receiver-in-canal (RIC)	Behind the ear, speaker in the canal	Mild to severe	Full day (rechargeable)	Most commonly fitted; discreet
In-the-ear (ITE)	Custom-moulded, fills the outer ear	Mild to moderately severe	Disposable batteries, 5 to 7 days	Easier to handle with limited dexterity
Completely-in-canal (CIC)	Deep in the ear canal, almost invisible	Mild to moderate only	Disposable batteries, 3 to 5 days	Smaller battery, more frequent replacement

Choosing a style

Your audiologist will recommend a style after your assessment. We do not recommend a style before a hearing test, because the right choice depends on your audiogram.

Rechargeable vs disposable batteries

Rechargeable models are available in BTE and RIC styles and last a full day on a single charge. ITE and CIC styles use small disposable batteries that need replacing every few days.